Tidewater Offshore Wind Outlook 2026

Fictional Institute for Coastal Energy (FICE), synthetic report

1. Summary

Installed offshore wind capacity in the fictional Tidewater region reached 4.2 GW at the end of 2025. FICE projects 9.8 GW by 2030 if the Marlow Bank auction clears on schedule. Grid connection queues remain the main constraint; the average wait for a connection offer rose from 14 to 22 months.

2. Capacity by zone

Table 1 lists installed and planned capacity by zone.

Zone	Installed 2025 (GW)	Planned 2030 (GW)
Marlow Bank	1.1	3.9
Grey Shoal	2.0	3.4
Esk Deep	1.1	2.5

3. Costs

The levelised cost of electricity for fixed-bottom projects fell to 61 EUR/MWh in the synthetic 2025 auction round, down from 74 EUR/MWh in 2023. Floating projects remain above 120 EUR/MWh. FICE attributes the decline to larger turbines (15 MW class) and lower financing costs.

4. Risks

Supply-chain bottlenecks for export cables and installation vessels are the largest schedule risk. A two-year slip at Marlow Bank would cut the 2030 projection to 7.6 GW.